

NAGALAND LITERACY AND NUMERACY FEST 2026

Cycle 1: Micro-Improvement Project (Literacy Teacher) — Grade 4

Write Your Own Poem — Chapter: Poetry (Recitation & Creative Writing)

Why this Micro-Improvement Project (MIP)?

In this MIP, students explored short stories, guessed the meaning of new words from context, and used enough vocabulary for day-to-day interaction. Now, they are ready to give voice to their own words through poetry. Across Nagaland, poetry and rhythm are part of everyday life: the rise and fall of a folk song sung while working in the fields, the rhythmic chants during a Hornbill Festival performance, the stories elders tell by the fireside in a Morung. This MIP helps students connect these everyday rhythms and stories to the craft of poetry — reciting with expression, responding to what they read, and writing their own poems about the land, culture, and ideas that matter to them.

Skill in Focus: Poetry Recitation (Rhythm, Stress & Intonation) and Creative Writing (Rhyme, Vocabulary & Message)

Duration: 1 Week

Learning Outcome

- Recites the poem with appropriate expression and intonation.
- Responds verbally and in writing (in English) to questions based on the poem read.
- Presents in writing the highlights of the learnings.

Key Concepts

- Recites poems aloud with rhythm, stress, and intonation, echoing and clapping the beat.
- Responds verbally and in writing to comprehension questions about a poem's message.
- Builds vocabulary using dictionaries and context clues, finding spelling and meaning of new words.
- Writes and reflects on original work, summarising the highlights of daily learning.

Competency Addressed

C-10.5: “Reads short stories and comprehends their meaning, identifying storyline and what the author wants to say on their own.”

C-9.7: “Knows and uses enough words for day-to-day interaction; guesses meaning of new words using existing vocabulary.”

Together, these two competencies anchor the MIP’s focus on listening, speaking, reading, and writing: learners recite with rhythm, stress, and intonation (speaking/listening), respond to and comprehend the poem (reading), and write and reflect on their own poem (writing).

Detailed Tasks

Task-1

Find Out What Students Already Know About Rhythm and Poetic Language

Objective

To find out, before any formal teaching, what each student already knows about rhythm, expression, and poetic language, so that Task-2 onward can be pitched at the right level for the class.

Teacher's Note

Needs no extra time or materials — only careful watching and listening during normal classroom and school activities across 2–3 days. Keep it conversational, not a test; note who responds with expression, who struggles to find words, and who needs the question repeated.

Duration

40 minutes

Materials Needed

None required — only the teacher’s notebook and pencil to jot observations.

Activity Steps

1. While reciting the morning prayer or pledge, ask: ‘Did that sound different when we said it together with rhythm?’
2. During story time, ask: ‘What word would you use to describe how that made you feel?’
3. While walking to assembly, ask: ‘Can you think of two words that rhyme with tree, or with rain?’
4. Note who responds with expression, who struggles to find words, and who needs the question repeated — pick 4–5 students to track on a simple checklist.

Sample checklist (pick 4–5 students for the diagnostic):

Student Name	Recites with Expression	Responds with Vocabulary	Identifies Rhyme	Needs Support
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐

Scale: ☐ Not Yet ☐ Sometimes ☐ Consistently

Concept Built

A baseline picture of how confidently each student uses rhythm, expression, and rhyming words in everyday speech, used to pace Tasks 2–4.

Task-2

Plan Daily Poetry and Recitation Activities Using Familiar Nagaland Contexts

Objective	To build a short, protected daily routine that connects rhythm, expression, and everyday experience to poetry, using contexts students already know.
Teacher's Note	Fix the same 10–15 minute slot in the timetable every day so the routine becomes a habit rather than an occasional activity. Draw on folk songs, harvest chants, local legends, or festival performances the students already know, and use words like rhythm, rhyme, message, and expression during vocabulary talk.
Duration	40 minutes

Materials Needed

None extra — uses the daily timetable slot, familiar songs/chants, and the poetry corner set up in Task-3.

Activity Steps

1. Fix a daily 10–15 minute poetry and recitation routine in the timetable.

2. Use familiar contexts such as folk songs, harvest chants, local legends, or festival performances.
3. Include vocabulary talk by asking questions using words like rhythm, rhyme, message, and expression.
4. Ensure every student gets a chance to recite, respond, and write during the month.

Concept Built

A short, protected daily routine turns rhythm and recitation into a habit, using songs, chants, and stories the students already know.

Task-3

Arrange Materials and Classroom Setup to Support Recitation and Writing

Objective

To set up a shared, low-cost poetry corner so every student can engage with rhythm, reference materials, and vocabulary supports concretely, throughout the month.

Teacher's Note

Ask students to share one item within their group, and keep poem copies and vocabulary charts in one corner of the classroom — this becomes the classroom's poetry kit for the month. Focus on students reciting, discussing, and writing rather than only reading silently.

Duration

40 minutes

Materials Needed

Poem Copies • Dictionaries • Bamboo Clappers • Pebble Shakers • Chart Paper • Sentence Strips • Picture Cards • Word Wall

Activity Steps

1. Use simple, locally available materials such as bamboo clappers, pebbles in a bottle, or tabletop taps for rhythm.
2. Arrange dictionaries, poem copies, and vocabulary charts in a common place so all students can access them easily.
3. Ensure students get opportunities to handle and use these materials during activities, not just observe them.
4. Ask students to share one item each within their group, building a joint classroom poetry kit for the month.

Concept Built

A shared, low-cost poetry corner gives every student hands-on access to rhythm tools, reference materials, and vocabulary supports throughout the month.

Task-4

Conduct Classroom Activities That Build Recitation, Comprehension, and Writing Skills

Objective

To give every student daily practice across the four strands of the MIP, reciting with expression, responding to a poem's message, building vocabulary, and reflecting in writing so understanding grows alongside performance.

Teacher's Note

Every student must participate every day. Keep activities short, energetic, and hands-on wherever possible. The goal is understanding students should be able to explain what their poem means and why, not just recite words. Teachers can modify or add more activities as per their context.

Duration

40 minutes

Materials Needed

The Task-3 poetry kit (bamboo clappers, pebble shakers) • Dictionaries • Poem copies • Notebooks for the Learning Highlights Journal

Activity Steps

Listening & Speaking (Recitation)

1. Choral Recitation: Teacher reads the poem aloud with rhythm and expression; students echo-read together, clapping a beat at the end of each line. Builds: recitation with expression and intonation.
2. Rhythm & Beat Practice: Students use bamboo clappers or pebble shakers to mark stress and pauses while reciting. Builds: stress and pause awareness in oral reading.

Reading & Comprehension

1. Message Circle: After reading, students sit in a circle and discuss what message the poem is trying to share, responding verbally and in writing. Builds: responding to questions on the poem read.

Writing

1. Word Detective: Students use a dictionary to find the spelling and meaning of unfamiliar words from the poem. Builds: vocabulary and spelling accuracy.

2. Learning Highlights Journal: Students write 2–3 lines summarising the highlights of what they learned each day.

Builds: presenting in writing the highlights of the learnings.

Concept Built

Students recite with expression, respond to a poem’s message, build vocabulary through dictionary and context work, and reflect in writing on their own, learning the four strands of the MIP practised together, every day.

Culminating Showcase

Showcase

My Own Poem — Write, Recite, and Reflect

Objective

To bring together every concept from Tasks 1–4 by having each student write an original poem using rhyme and vocabulary, recite it with expression, and reflect on their own learning journey.

Teacher's Note

Let students choose their own subject land, family, festivals, or an everyday moment so the poem feels personally meaningful. Encourage the use of rhyme, homophones, adjectives, synonyms, or antonyms, but do not insist on perfect rhyme; message and voice matter more than technical polish. A shared, low-pressure recitation circle works as well as a formal stage.

Duration

40 minutes

Materials Needed

Notebooks or plain paper • Pencils, crayons, or sketch pens for illustrating the poem • Word wall and dictionaries from the poetry corner • Bamboo clappers or pebble shakers for the recitation

Activity Steps

1. Day 1 (20 min): Each student chooses a subject that matters to them: their village, a festival, a family member, the hills and drafts a short original poem (4–8 lines), using at least one rhyme and one new vocabulary word from the word wall.
2. Day 1 (10 min): Students revise their draft with a partner, checking rhythm when read aloud and whether the message is clear.
3. Day 2 (10 min): Students recite their own poem to a small group or the class, using the expression and rhythm techniques practised in Task-4.
4. Day 2 (5–10 min): Whole-class reflection and Learning Highlights entry about what was easy or hard about writing their own poem, and what they are proud of.

Concept Built

Independent application of rhythm, rhyme, vocabulary, and message-crafting in an original poem that each student writes, recites, and reflects on.

By the end of these tasks, teachers and students should have moved from everyday rhythms and rhymes to confidently reciting, comprehending, and writing poetry culminating in an original poem that each student can recite and showcase with pride.

Micro-Improvement Cycle of Literacy Teacher

In this MIP you focused on:

- Helping students recite poems with appropriate rhythm, stress, and intonation.
- Guiding students to respond verbally and in writing to questions based on what they read.
- Building vocabulary through dictionary use and inferring meaning from context.
- Encouraging students to write original poems using rhyme, homophones, adjectives, synonyms, and antonyms.
- Presenting in writing the highlights of their learning through short reflective writing.
- Using familiar Nagaland contexts — folk songs, festival chants, morung storytelling — to connect poetry to everyday life.

Reflect on Students' Understanding

Observe 5–6 students each week during the activities above. No written test is needed — watch what children do while reciting and listen to how they explain their thinking. Encourage progress, not perfection.

Student Name	Recites with Rhythm, Stress & Intonation	Responds to Comprehension Qs	Writes Using Vocabulary & Rhyme	Needs Support
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐

Scale (for each column): ☐ Not Yet ☐ Sometimes ☐ Consistently

Picture Guide